



ROUND TABLE DISCUSSION ON CLIMATE CRISIS AND FOOD SOVEREIGNTY

ON THE OCCASION OF 43rd WORLD FOOD DAY, 2023

📍 Mid Baneshwor, Kathmandu, Nepal

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Organized by:

Digo Bikas Institute (DBI)
Kathmandu, Nepal

DIGO BIKAS
INSTITUTE

Food First Information Network (FIAN)
Kathmandu, Nepal



Alliance of Agriculture for Food (AoAF)
Lalitpur, Nepal



Right to Food Network (RIFIN)



National Farmers Group Federation (NFGF)
Kathmandu, Nepal



Contributors

Kadambini Gurung
Prayash Adhikari
Abhishek Shrestha

Designer

Omkar Subedi



Introduction:

In response to the growing global food crisis exacerbated by extreme weather and prolonged dry seasons, which disproportionately affects small-scale farmers, the Digo Bikas Institute (DBI) together with Food First Information Network (FIAN) Nepal, Alliance of Agriculture for Food (AoAF), Right to Food Network (RIFIN) and National Farmers Group Federation (NFGF), organized a crucial "Round Table Discussion on Climate Crisis and Food Sovereignty" on the occasion of 43rd world food day 2023. It was held on the 12th of October 2023 at the conference hall of Hotel Le Himalaya, Lazimpat- Kathmandu. The primary objective of this event was to engage in policy discussions concerning climate-induced food crises and food sovereignty in Nepal.

Objectives:

The event aims to bring together various stakeholders, including parliamentarians, civil society organizations (CSOs), experts, and community representatives, to address critical issues related to climate change impacts on food sovereignty and sustainable agricultural practices.

1. Initiate the course of discussion over the need to understand and address the causes and challenges of climate-induced food crises.
2. Encourage policy discussions that advocate for sustainable agricultural policies that balance the interests of communities and the environment.
3. Discuss the role and engagement of parliamentarians in addressing climate-induced food crises, seeking actionable commitments for policy formulation and implementation.
4. Encourage parliamentarians to prioritize the farmers based agroecology and indigenous knowledge against corporate based false solutions to climate crisis such as Climate Smart Agriculture in policy making.

Agenda:

The workshop agenda consisted of a presentation on the current overview, present and future prospects, as well as the global and national scenarios regarding the climate crisis and food sovereignty, a question and answer round and a speech by the member of parliament. The session was designed to encourage active participation and facilitate meaningful discussions among participants. The program was facilitated by Dipesh Nepal from the Alliance of Agriculture for Food (AoAF).

Key Discussion Points:

- Emphasis on addressing the causes and challenges related to climate-induced food crises and food sovereignty.
- Concern about the technocratic false solutions proposed so far in the name of food security and climate solutions such as climate-smart agriculture which is destroying our native smallholder farmers-based agroecosystem.
- Consideration of the political economy's role in addressing the climate crisis and food sovereignty concerns.
- Discussion on seed quality, agricultural productivity, food safety, and public health about climate-induced challenges.
- Addressing the role of community forests and their integration into agricultural solutions for sustainability.
- Recognition of the roles and responsibilities of both government and citizens in addressing climate-induced food crises.
- Concerns about the state of knowledge documentation, validity of annual reports, and research findings informing policy decisions.
- Discussion on financial moderation and preservation of diversity and indigenous knowledge.
- Importance of recognizing and addressing the needs of vulnerable groups impacted by climate change.



Discussions and Recommendations:

Participants engaged in a fruitful dialogue, seeking clarification and deeper insights into the critical issues at hand. Some topics that were conveyed in the discussion were ‘the importance of addressing the causes and challenges of the issue’, ‘focus on advocating against both communism and capitalism’, ‘political economy’, ‘seed quality and agricultural productivity’, ‘food safety and public health’, ‘addressing the role of community forests and their integration into agricultural solutions’, ‘government and citizen roles’ and ‘the importance of assessing and minimizing carbon footprints in events related to climate crises’. Questions regarding the state of documentation of knowledge, ‘implementation challenges’, and ‘the validity and thorough analysis of annual reports and research findings to inform policy decisions’ were also raised during the questionnaire round. Key topics of ‘Financial Moderation’, and ‘Preservation of Diversity and Indigenous Knowledge’ were also addressed. The importance of recognizing vulnerable groups impacted by climate change and the importance of addressing their specific needs along with the significance of understanding farmers’ backgrounds and communities for effective agricultural solutions were topics that were highlighted as important by the audience during the discussion. The audience also raised discussions against capitalism in the context of food sovereignty, advocating for a more decentralized approach where local communities have greater control over their food systems.

Honorable Metmani Chaudhary addressed concerns regarding low per-unit production, overproduction, and frequent constitutional changes. He advocated for youth involvement in policy-making and emphasized the need for parliamentary members to be more informed and engaged, particularly in the climate crisis and food sovereignty issues.

Laxmi Gurung from Food First Information Network (FIAN) concluded the event by summarizing discussions and outlining the way forward. She acknowledged the difficulties in working with diverse communities and highlighted the importance of involving farmers, particularly female farmers, in policy implementation. Laxmi Gurung stressed the need for effective policy dissemination and government responsibility, urging for localized adaptation planning and methods to address climate crises at the local level.

Conclusion:

The identified focal points, ranging from addressing fundamental causes and challenges to recognizing the roles of government and citizens, underscored the multifaceted nature of the issue at hand. The imperative to balance economic approaches, promotion of ecology-based farming approaches, documentation promotion and prioritization of indigenous knowledge over corporate based practices, sustainable agrifood systems that prioritize domestic food needs, and resultantly ensure adequate, healthy, culturally-appropriate, and affordable food for all emphasized a holistic perspective in addressing climate-induced food crises.

In summary, the event's discussions and deliberations underscored the critical importance of collaborative efforts and a comprehensive understanding of the interwoven challenges associated with climate-induced food crises and food sovereignty. It reinforced the necessity for continued engagement, research, and advocacy to devise sustainable solutions that prioritize the well-being of communities, uphold environmental sustainability, and ensure food security for all.



Honorable Metmani Chaudhary sharing his thoughts on the discussion



Ramhari Sharma from NFGF giving his opening statement



Prayash Adhikari from DBI presenting on climate crisis and food sovereignty



Media Coverage

हलो समाचार सफल कथा पशुपन्थी प्रविधि विचार कौसी क्वीन किसानको आवाज बैंक खबर अनुदान किसान

बुधबार १०-३-२०८०

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हलोखबर २०८० असोज २६ गते प्रकाशित

102 SHARES

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कृत्रिम गर्भाधानबाट सुत्केरी पशुलाई भत्ता

शारीरिक अपाङ्गता भएका युवराज



ANNEX – I Program Schedule

S.N.	Activity	Time	Moderation/ Facilitation
1.	Tea & Registration	13:30-13:45	
2.	Welcome and Introduction	13:45-14:00	NFGF
3	Climate change and food sovereignty: present and future crisis	14:00-14:15	DBI
4	Parliamentarians engagement and efforts to address climate induced food crisis and food sovereignty in Nepal	14:15-14:50	AoAF
5	Q & A	14:50-15:10	Moderator
6	Conclusion and way forward	15:10-15:30	FIAN
	Hi Tea	15:30 onwards	



ANNEX – I I List of Participants

S.N.	NAME	INSTITUTION
1	Biddhya Pandey	We for change
2	Arnab Chaudhary	Harin Nepal/ LCOY 2023
3	Dikshya Subedi	Youth action for Sustainable and Eco Nepal/ LCOY 2023
4	Kalyani Bhandari	CJSS Alumni
5	Safal Subba	ANPFa Nepal
6	Saugat Bhattarai	Rural Reconstruction Nepal (RRN)
7	Teeka Bhattarai	Centre for Educational Policies and Practices (CEPP)
8	Abhisekh Khadka	Rural Reconstruction Nepal (RRN)
9	Asmita Khanal	Youth Advocacy Nepal (YAN)
10	Dhurba Magar	Krishi Journal
11	Dipesh Nepal	Alliance of agriculture for food
12	Tara Nidhi Panta	General Federation of Nepalese Trade Unions (GEFONT)
13	Manoj Shrestha	Halo khabar
14	Karuna Parajuli	International Commission of Jurists (ICJ)
15	Sabita Mahat	Jagaran Nepal
16	Shree Ram Subedi	Nagarik News
17	Dipika Khadka	Nepalese Youth for Climate Action (NYCA)
18	Preeti Pandey	Nepalese Youth for Climate Action (NYCA)
19	Preeti Kayastha	Nepal Agricultural Research Council (NARC)
20	Anup Subedi	Centre for Educational Policies and Practices (CEPP)
21	Bijaya Subba	Digo Bikas Institute (DBI)
22	Bindu K. Rokaya	Youth Advocacy Nepal (YAN)
23	Dipshika Gautam	Youth Advocacy Nepal (YAN)
24	Kadambini Gurung	Digo Bikas Institute (DBI)
25	Susmita Adhikari	Youth Initiatives (YI)

S.N.	NAME	INSTITUTION
26	Sabina Acharya	Himalayan College of Agriculture Science and Technology (HICAST)
27	Urmila Bohara	Himalayan College of Agriculture Science and Technology (HICAST)
28	Shiksha Khanal	Land our Future
29	Shrijana Gautam	We for change
30	Srijana Poudel	Forest Action Nepal
31	Upama Acharya	Nepalese Youth for Climate Action (NYCA)
32	Samita Thapaliya	We for change
33	Parbata Gautam	Federation of Community Forestry Users Nepal (FECOFUN)
34	Dipesh Chaudhary	COLARP
35	Bivuti Basnet	We for change
36	Yunisha Katuwal	We for change
37	Avinash Jha	Digo Bikas Institute (DBI)
38	Apeksha Chalise	Digo Bikas Institute (DBI)
39	Jelina Karki	Human Right Alliance
40	Abisekh Shrestha	Digo Bikas Institute (DBI)
41	Binisha Shrestha	Digo Bikas Institute (DBI)
42	Laxmi Gurung	FIAN Nepal
43	Barsha KC	Digo Bikas Institute (DBI)
44	Ranjan Raj Dahal	Digo Bikas Institute (DBI)
45	Ram Hari Sharma	National Farmers Group Federation (NFGF)
46	Pratistha Subedi	Jagaran Nepal
47	Prayash Adhikari	Digo Bikas Institute (DBI)
48	John Rai	Digo Bikas Institute (DBI)
49	Sabin Rimal	Digo Bikas Institute (DBI)

